

Install Obsidian on Windows

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Before you begin

Obsidian is free to download and use. You do not need an account for the app. Your vault is an ordinary folder on your PC.

Install

1. Go to <https://obsidian.md/download>.
2. Under Windows, select Universal.
3. Open the downloaded installer.
4. Follow the installer instructions.
5. Open Obsidian from the Start menu.

Create your first vault

6. Choose Create new vault.
7. Name it Genealogy Research.
8. Choose a location you can find again, such as Documents.
9. Select Create.

Find the files later

In File Explorer, open the folder you chose. Every note is a plain .md text file. PDFs and images can live in the same vault.

Recommended for the workshop: keep the vault local first. Add syncing only after the basic workflow feels comfortable.

OneDrive, Dropbox, and backup

- Cloud folders can work, but make sure files remain available offline and let syncing finish before switching devices.
- Avoid two services syncing the same vault. Obsidian warns that mixing Obsidian Sync with another provider can create conflicts.
- Sync is not a backup. Keep a separate backup copy.

Official sources

obsidian.md/help/install • obsidian.md/pricing • obsidian.md/help/sync